

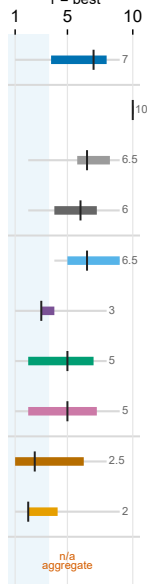
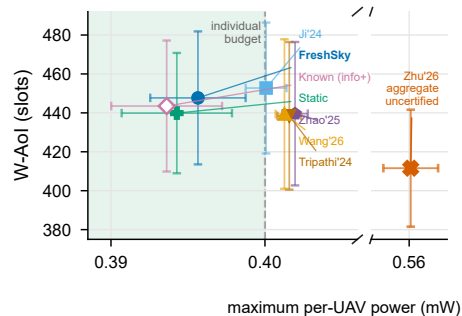
(a) Paired improvement matrix + rank stability

cell = mean [95% CI]; + FreshSky better; * CI excludes 0

		$d = 2$	$d = 4$	$d = 8$
	FreshSky	REF paired anchor	REF paired anchor	REF paired anchor
Conservative age	◀	+15.9 [+14.1, +17.8]	+26.8 [+25.0, +28.6]	+41.1 [+39.1, +43.1]
Max-Age	●	+4.0 [+1.8, +6.2]	+0.9 [-1.5, +3.3]	-0.2 [-2.5, +2.0]
Round-Robin	▶	+2.7 [+1.1, +4.4]	+0.5 [-1.2, +2.2]	-0.9 [-2.4, +0.6]
Ji'24 greedy	■	+2.2 [+0.9, +3.4]	+1.2 [-0.1, +2.5]	+1.3 [+0.0, +2.6]
Zhao'25 MW-E	◆	-0.1 [-1.9, +1.7]	-2.2 [-4.1, -0.2]	-3.2 [-5.0, -1.4]
Static DPP-MC	+	-0.9 [-2.1, +0.2]	-1.6 [-3.2, -0.1]	-0.4 [-1.4, +0.6]
Known transition	◇	-0.9 [-2.4, +0.6]	-1.0 [-2.6, +0.7]	-1.9 [-3.2, -0.7]
Tripathi'24 WI	▼	+0.2 [-1.8, +2.2]	-2.6 [-5.4, +0.2]	-3.3 [-5.8, -0.9]
Wang'26 PORMAB	▲	-0.5 [-2.8, +1.7]	-2.4 [-4.7, -0.0]	-3.5 [-5.6, -1.5]
Zhu'26 agg.-DPP	✱	-8.6 [-10.9, -6.4]	-8.7 [-11.2, -6.3]	-7.5 [-9.5, -5.4]

rank @ $d = 4$

1 = best

**(b) $d = 4$ contract plane****(c) Shift boundary: paired pre/post**